



Session 11B: Trigonometric Identities, Equations, and Beyond

Phase 2 — Classical Techniques | 135 min

Prerequisite: [11A — Trigonometric Foundations](#) (radians, unit circle, six trig functions, graphs, inverse trig)

This session assumes fluency with: degree $\leftrightarrow$ radian conversion, all six trig values from the unit circle, graph sketching with transformations, and arcsin/arccos/arctan evaluation. If shaky, review 11A first.

Part A: Trigonometric Identities — Your Algebraic Arsenal

Example 1: Sum and Difference Formulas — Splitting and Merging Angles

Start with two angles whose trig values you know: 45° and 30° .

Find $\sin 75^\circ$: $75^\circ = 45^\circ + 30^\circ$.

$$\begin{aligned}\sin 75^\circ &= \sin 45^\circ \cos 30^\circ + \cos 45^\circ \sin 30^\circ \\ &= \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} + \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} \cdot \frac{1}{2} = \frac{\sqrt{6} + \sqrt{2}}{4}.\end{aligned}$$

Find $\cos 15^\circ$: $15^\circ = 45^\circ - 30^\circ$.

$$\begin{aligned}\cos 15^\circ &= \cos 45^\circ \cos 30^\circ + \sin 45^\circ \sin 30^\circ \\ &= \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} + \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} \cdot \frac{1}{2} = \frac{\sqrt{6} + \sqrt{2}}{4}.\end{aligned}$$

Find $\tan 75^\circ$: $\tan 75^\circ = \frac{\tan 45^\circ + \tan 30^\circ}{1 - \tan 45^\circ \tan 30^\circ} = \frac{1 + 1/\sqrt{3}}{1 - 1/\sqrt{3}} = 2 + \sqrt{3}.$

Find $\sin 105^\circ$: $105^\circ = 60^\circ + 45^\circ$.

$\sin 105^\circ = \sin 60^\circ \cos 45^\circ + \cos 60^\circ \sin 45^\circ = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} + \frac{1}{2} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} = \frac{\sqrt{6} + \sqrt{2}}{4}$. Same as $\sin 75^\circ$.

The six formulas:

$$\sin(A + B) = \sin A \cos B + \cos A \sin B$$

$$\sin(A - B) = \sin A \cos B - \cos A \sin B$$

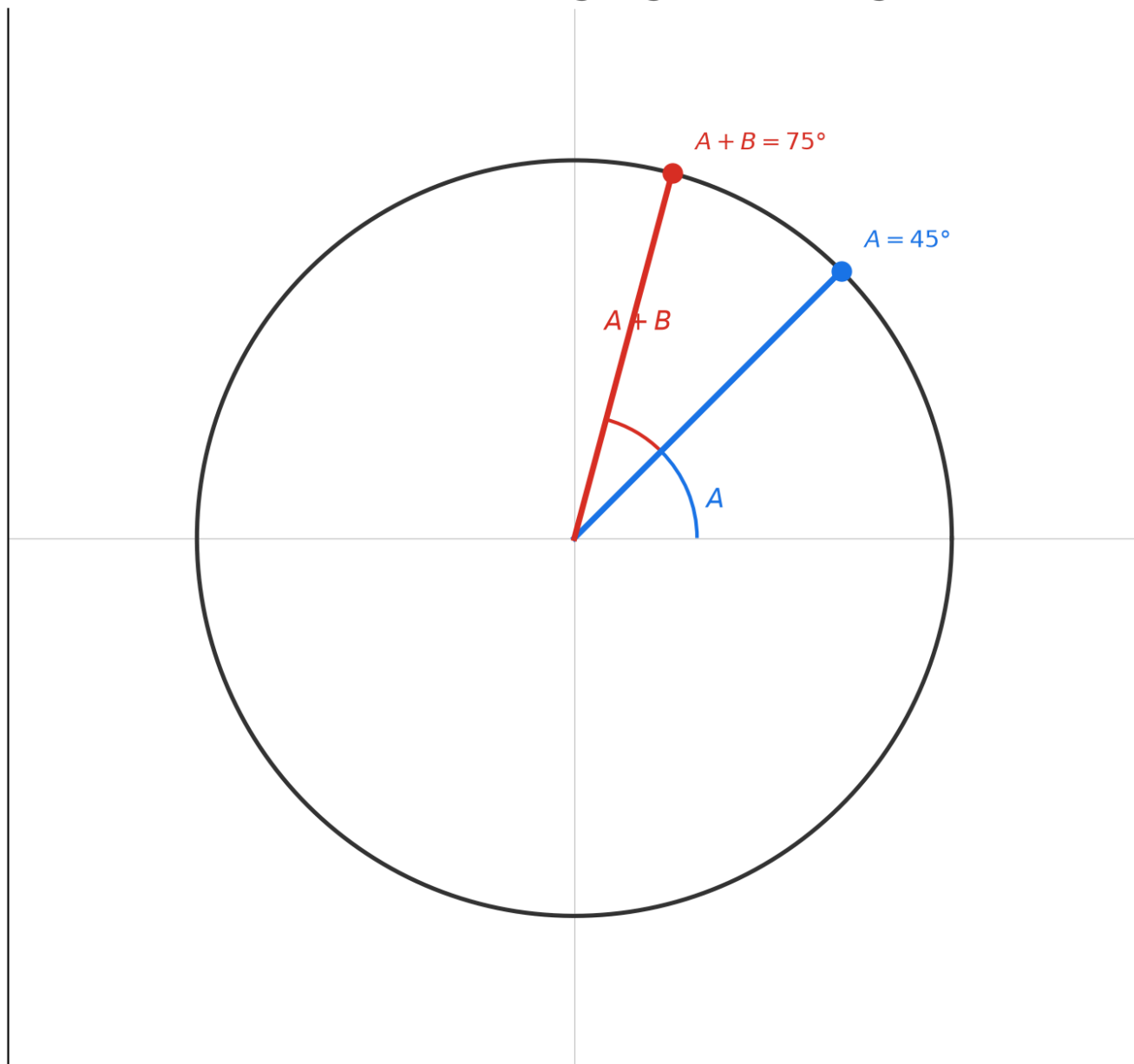
$$\cos(A + B) = \cos A \cos B - \sin A \sin B$$

$$\cos(A - B) = \cos A \cos B + \sin A \sin B$$

$$\tan(A + B) = \frac{\tan A + \tan B}{1 - \tan A \tan B}$$

$$\tan(A - B) = \frac{\tan A - \tan B}{1 + \tan A \tan B}$$

$$e^{i(A+B)} = e^{iA}e^{iB}: \text{Adding Angles} = \text{Rotating}$$



Geometric insight: $e^{i(A+B)} = e^{iA}e^{iB}$. Expanding $(\cos A + i \sin A)(\cos B + i \sin B)$ and matching real/imaginary parts gives all four sin/cos formulas at once — no memorization needed.

Method — Computing a sum/difference trig value in 3 steps:

- (1) **Pick the formula.** Is it sin, cos, or tan? Sum or difference? Write it out.
- (2) **Plug in the known values.** Read sin and cos of the two component angles from the special-angle table. Multiply carefully; watch the signs ($\pm$ and $\mp$).

(3) **Simplify the radical expression.** Combine like terms. For tan, rationalize the denominator if needed.

 **Pro tip — Picking the split:** To compute $\sin 105^\circ$, split as $60^\circ + 45^\circ$ (both special angles) rather than $90^\circ + 15^\circ$ (15° is not a basic special angle). Always split into angles from $\{0^\circ, 30^\circ, 45^\circ, 60^\circ, 90^\circ\}$.

Example 2: Double-Angle, Half-Angle, and Triple-Angle

Set $A = B = \theta$ in the sum formulas:

$$\sin 2\theta = 2 \sin \theta \cos \theta.$$

$$\cos 2\theta = \cos^2 \theta - \sin^2 \theta = 2 \cos^2 \theta - 1 = 1 - 2 \sin^2 \theta.$$

$$\tan 2\theta = \frac{2 \tan \theta}{1 - \tan^2 \theta}.$$

Given $\sin \theta = \frac{3}{5}$ with θ in QI, find $\sin 2\theta$ and $\cos 2\theta$:

(1) Find $\cos \theta$: $\cos \theta = \sqrt{1 - \frac{9}{25}} = \frac{4}{5}.$

(2) $\sin 2\theta = 2 \cdot \frac{3}{5} \cdot \frac{4}{5} = \frac{24}{25}.$

(3) $\cos 2\theta = 2 \cos^2 \theta - 1 = 2 \cdot \frac{16}{25} - 1 = \frac{7}{25}.$

Given $\cos \theta = -\frac{3}{5}$ with θ in QII, find $\sin 2\theta$:

(1) $\sin \theta = \sqrt{1 - \frac{9}{25}} = \frac{4}{5}$ (positive in QII).

(2) $\sin 2\theta = 2 \cdot \frac{4}{5} \cdot \left(-\frac{3}{5}\right) = -\frac{24}{25}.$

(3) $\cos 2\theta = 1 - 2 \sin^2 \theta = 1 - 2 \cdot \frac{16}{25} = -\frac{7}{25}.$

Half-angle — from $\cos 2\theta = 2 \cos^2 \theta - 1$, replace $\theta \rightarrow \theta/2$:

$$\cos \theta = 2 \cos^2 \frac{\theta}{2} - 1 \rightarrow \cos^2 \frac{\theta}{2} = \frac{1 + \cos \theta}{2}.$$

$$\sin^2 \frac{\theta}{2} = \frac{1 - \cos \theta}{2}.$$

Find $\sin 15^\circ$ via half-angle of 30° :

$$\sin^2 15^\circ = \frac{1 - \cos 30^\circ}{2} = \frac{1 - \sqrt{3}/2}{2} = \frac{2 - \sqrt{3}}{4}.$$

$$\sin 15^\circ = \frac{\sqrt{2 - \sqrt{3}}}{2} = \frac{\sqrt{6} - \sqrt{2}}{4} \text{ (rationalizing).}$$

Triple-angle:

$$\sin 3\theta = 3 \sin \theta - 4 \sin^3 \theta.$$

$$\cos 3\theta = 4 \cos^3 \theta - 3 \cos \theta.$$

$$\tan 3\theta = \frac{3 \tan \theta - \tan^3 \theta}{1 - 3 \tan^2 \theta}.$$

Geometric insight: Double-angle = rotating twice on the unit circle. The three forms of $\cos 2\theta$ are the same curve — choose the one matching what you already know ($\sin \theta$, $\cos \theta$, or both).

Method — Choosing the right $\cos 2\theta$ form in 3 steps:

(1) **Look at what you have.** Know $\sin \theta \rightarrow$ use $1 - 2 \sin^2 \theta$. Know $\cos \theta \rightarrow$ use $2 \cos^2 \theta - 1$. Know both $\rightarrow$ use $\cos^2 \theta - \sin^2 \theta$.

(2) **Plug in and compute.** Square first, multiply by 2, then add or subtract.

(3) **For half-angle, decide the sign.** $\frac{\theta}{2}$ may be in a different quadrant. Check: if $\theta \in [0, \pi]$, then $\frac{\theta}{2} \in [0, \frac{\pi}{2}] \rightarrow$ all positive. If $\theta \in (\pi, 2\pi)$, then $\frac{\theta}{2} \in (\frac{\pi}{2}, \pi) \rightarrow$ sin positive, cos negative.

 **Pro tip — The three faces of $\cos 2\theta$:** When you need $\cos 2\theta$ and already know $\sin \theta$, use $1 - 2 \sin^2 \theta$ — no need to find $\cos \theta$ first. When you know $\cos \theta$, use $2 \cos^2 \theta - 1$.

This saves a Pythagorean step and avoids sign ambiguity.

Example 3: Harmonic Addition — $a \sin x + b \cos x$ into One Wave

$$3 \sin x + 4 \cos x: R = \sqrt{3^2 + 4^2} = 5. \phi = \arctan \frac{4}{3} \approx 53.13^\circ.$$

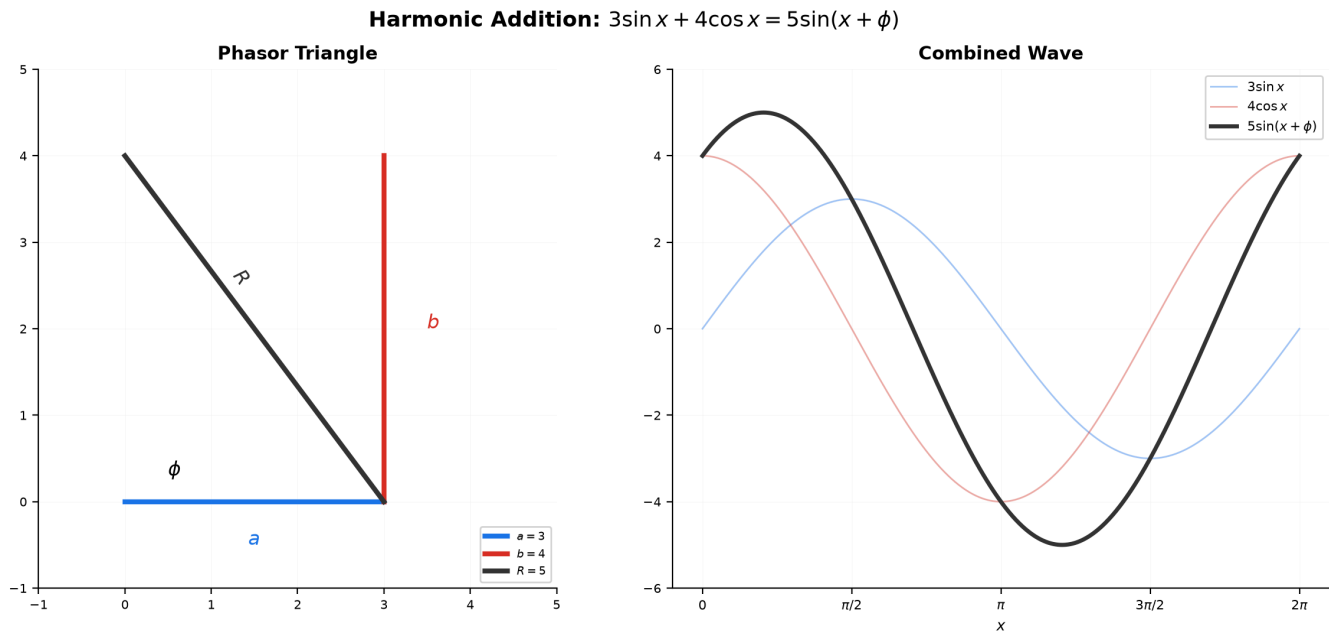
Result: $5 \sin(x + \phi)$.

$$\sqrt{3} \sin x - \cos x: R = \sqrt{3 + 1} = 2. \phi = \arctan \frac{-1}{\sqrt{3}} = -\frac{\pi}{6}. \text{ Result: } 2 \sin(x - \frac{\pi}{6}).$$

$\sin x + \cos x$: $R = \sqrt{2}$. $\phi = \arctan 1 = \frac{\pi}{4}$. Result: $\sqrt{2} \sin(x + \frac{\pi}{4})$.

$5 \sin x + 12 \cos x$: $R = \sqrt{25 + 144} = 13$. $\phi = \arctan \frac{12}{5}$. Result: $13 \sin(x + \phi)$, max value = 13.

Why this matters: $a \sin x + b \cos x$ appears in physics (superposition of waves), engineering (AC circuits), and differential equations. Reducing it to one wave makes amplitude and phase obvious.



Geometric insight: (a, b) is a point in the plane. R = distance from origin, ϕ = angle from positive x -axis. The expression is the projection of a rotating vector — a pure sine wave of amplitude R , shifted by ϕ .

Method — Harmonic addition in 3 steps:

- (1) **Compute R .** Square both coefficients, add them, take the square root. $R = \sqrt{a^2 + b^2}$.
- (2) **Find ϕ .** The right triangle has legs a (horizontal) and b (vertical). $\phi = \arctan \frac{b}{a}$, adjusted for quadrant: if $a < 0$, add π to $\arctan$.
- (3) **Write the result.** $a \sin x + b \cos x = R \sin(x + \phi)$. Alternative: $R \cos(x - \phi')$ with $\phi' = \arctan \frac{a}{b}$.

Pro tip — Existence check: Before solving $a \sin x + b \cos x = c$, compute $R = \sqrt{a^2 + b^2}$. If $|c| > R$, stop — no solution exists. If $|c| = R$, exactly one solution per period.

If $|c| < R$, two solutions. Saves time on impossible equations.

Example 4: Product-to-Sum and Sum-to-Product

Product-to-sum — turn multiplication into addition:

$$\begin{aligned}\sin A \cos B &= \frac{1}{2}[\sin(A + B) + \sin(A - B)] \\ \cos A \cos B &= \frac{1}{2}[\cos(A + B) + \cos(A - B)] \\ \sin A \sin B &= \frac{1}{2}[\cos(A - B) - \cos(A + B)]\end{aligned}$$

Compute $\sin 75^\circ \cos 15^\circ$:

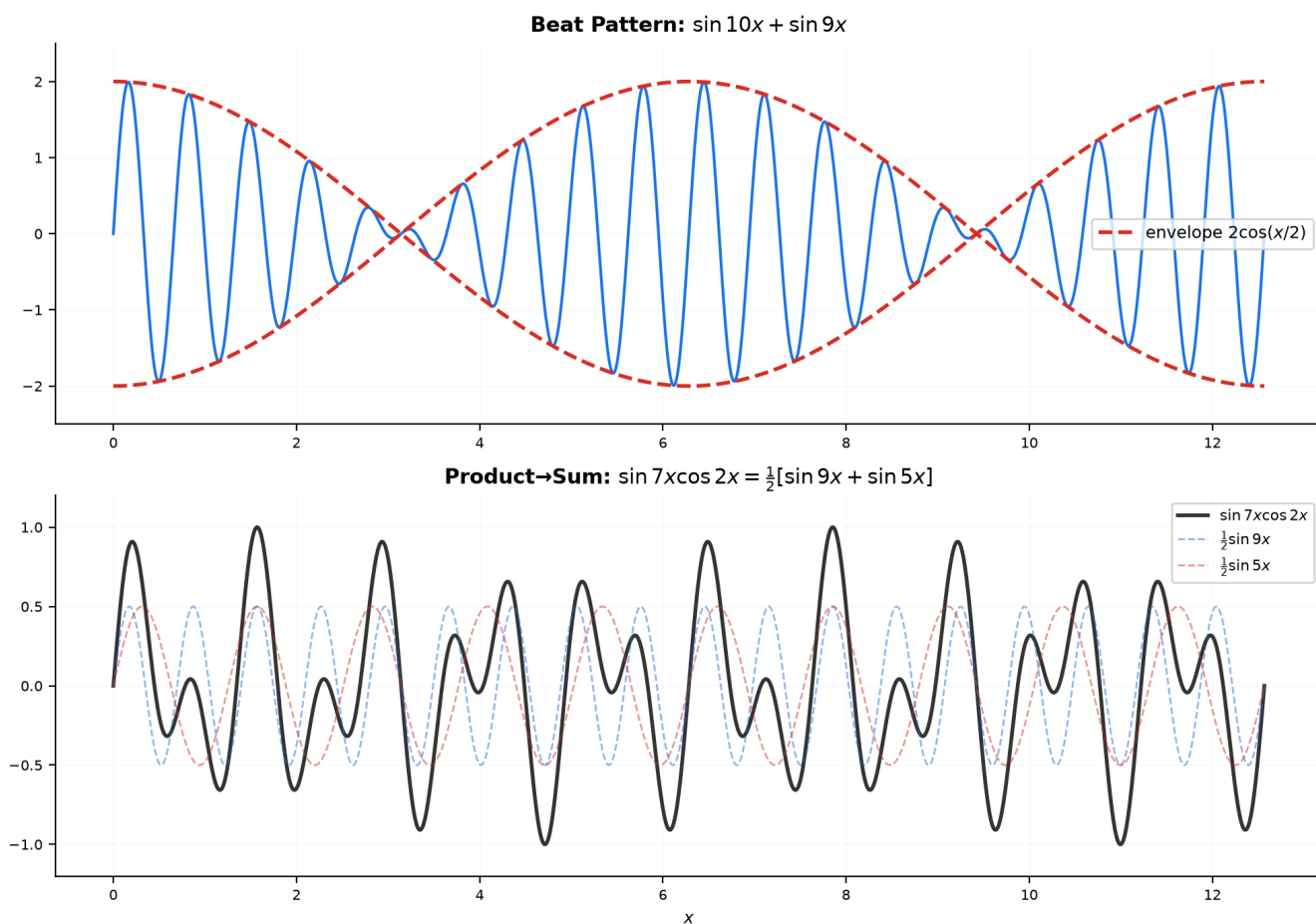
$$= \frac{1}{2}[\sin 90^\circ + \sin 60^\circ] = \frac{1}{2}\left[1 + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right] = \frac{2+\sqrt{3}}{4}.$$

Sum-to-product — turn addition into multiplication:

$$\begin{aligned}\sin A + \sin B &= 2 \sin \frac{A+B}{2} \cos \frac{A-B}{2} \\ \sin A - \sin B &= 2 \cos \frac{A+B}{2} \sin \frac{A-B}{2} \\ \cos A + \cos B &= 2 \cos \frac{A+B}{2} \cos \frac{A-B}{2} \\ \cos A - \cos B &= -2 \sin \frac{A+B}{2} \sin \frac{A-B}{2}\end{aligned}$$

Simplify $\sin 75^\circ + \sin 15^\circ$:

$$= 2 \sin 45^\circ \cos 30^\circ = 2 \cdot \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} = \frac{\sqrt{6}}{2}.$$



Geometric insight: When $A \approx B$, $\sin A + \sin B$ produces a "beat" — a fast oscillation inside a slow envelope. The sum-to-product formula reveals the envelope ($2 \cos \frac{A-B}{2}$) explicitly.

Method — Deciding which direction in 3 steps:

- (1) **Read the operation.** Multiplication of trigs → product-to-sum. Addition/subtraction of trigs → sum-to-product.
- (2) **Identify A and B .** The larger argument first.
- (3) **Apply the formula and simplify.** Product-to-sum: compute $A + B$ and $A - B$, multiply by $\frac{1}{2}$. Sum-to-product: compute $\frac{A+B}{2}$ and $\frac{A-B}{2}$, multiply by 2.



Pro tip — When sum-to-product beats double-angle: For $\sin 5x = \sin 3x$, rewriting as $\sin 5x - \sin 3x = 0$ and using sum-to-product gives $2 \cos 4x \sin x = 0$ — factorized immediately. Using triple-angle would produce a messy cubic. **Rule:** same function, different arguments → sum-to-product.

Example 5: Power-Reduction — Squares into First Powers

From $\cos 2\theta$ formulas, solve for $\sin^2 \theta$ and $\cos^2 \theta$:

$$\sin^2 \theta = \frac{1 - \cos 2\theta}{2}, \cos^2 \theta = \frac{1 + \cos 2\theta}{2}, \tan^2 \theta = \frac{1 - \cos 2\theta}{1 + \cos 2\theta}.$$

Compute $\sin^2 75^\circ$: $\frac{1 - \cos 150^\circ}{2} = \frac{1 - (-\sqrt{3}/2)}{2} = \frac{2 + \sqrt{3}}{4}.$

Compute $\cos^2 \frac{\pi}{8}$: $\frac{1 + \cos \frac{\pi}{4}}{2} = \frac{1 + \sqrt{2}/2}{2} = \frac{2 + \sqrt{2}}{4}.$

For cubes — invert the triple-angle formulas:

$$\sin^3 \theta = \frac{3 \sin \theta - \sin 3\theta}{4}, \cos^3 \theta = \frac{3 \cos \theta + \cos 3\theta}{4}.$$

Why these matter: $\int \sin^2 x \, dx$ is impossible without power-reduction. The identity turns $\sin^2 x = \frac{1}{2} - \frac{1}{2} \cos 2x$, and each term integrates trivially.

Method — Reducing a power in 3 steps:

(1) **Check the parity.** Even power ($\sin^2, \cos^4$) $\rightarrow$ use $\sin^2 \theta = \frac{1 - \cos 2\theta}{2}$ repeatedly. Odd power ($\sin^3$) $\rightarrow$ use $\sin^3 \theta = \frac{3 \sin \theta - \sin 3\theta}{4}.$

(2) **Apply the formula.** For $\sin^4 \theta$: $(\frac{1 - \cos 2\theta}{2})^2 = \frac{1 - 2 \cos 2\theta + \cos^2 2\theta}{4}.$ Then reduce $\cos^2 2\theta$ again.

(3) **Simplify to first-power cosines.** The result is a sum of $\cos(k\theta)$ terms. This is the form needed for integration.

Up to here: Sum/difference (6 formulas). Double/half/triple angle. Harmonic addition: $a \sin x + b \cos x \rightarrow R \sin(x + \phi).$ Product $\leftrightarrow$ sum. Power-reduction. These tools are for simplifying, solving, and proving.

Part B: Trigonometric Equations and Inequalities

Example 6: Basic Equations — Base Angle + $n \times$ Period

$$\sin x = \frac{1}{2}:$$

(1) Base angle: $\arcsin \frac{1}{2} = \frac{\pi}{6}$.

(2) Sine positive in QI and QII $\rightarrow x = \frac{\pi}{6}$ and $x = \pi - \frac{\pi}{6} = \frac{5\pi}{6}$.

(3) General: $x = \frac{\pi}{6} + 2n\pi$ or $x = \frac{5\pi}{6} + 2n\pi, n \in \mathbb{Z}$.

$$\cos x = -\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}:$$

(1) Base: $\arccos \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} = \frac{\pi}{6}$. Cosine negative in QII and QIII.

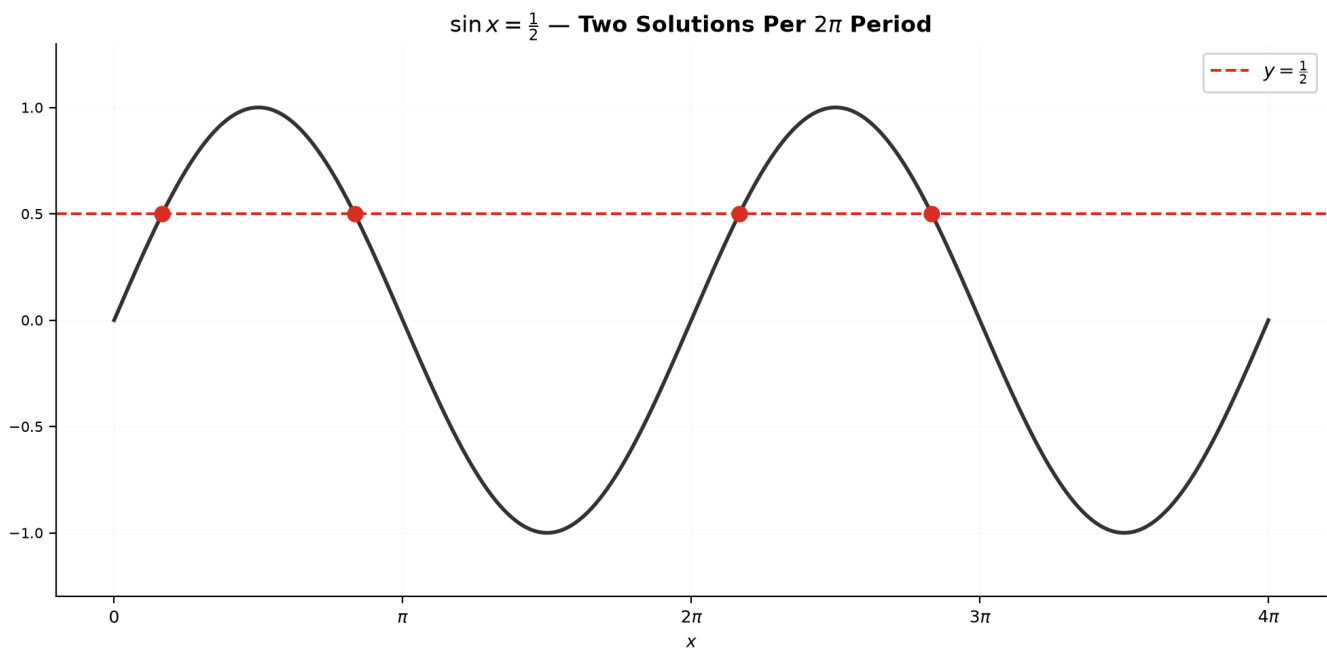
(2) $x = \pi - \frac{\pi}{6} = \frac{5\pi}{6}, x = \pi + \frac{\pi}{6} = \frac{7\pi}{6}$.

(3) General: $x = \frac{5\pi}{6} + 2n\pi$ or $x = \frac{7\pi}{6} + 2n\pi$.

$$\tan x = -1:$$

(1) Base: $\arctan 1 = \frac{\pi}{4}$. Tangent negative in QII and QIV: $\frac{3\pi}{4}, \frac{7\pi}{4}$.

(2) Period of tan is $\pi \rightarrow$ general: $x = \frac{3\pi}{4} + n\pi$.



Method — Any basic trig equation in 3 steps:

(1) **Find the base angle.** $\alpha = \arcsin |k|$ (or $\arccos |k|, \arctan |k|$). This is the QI reference.

(2) **Determine all quadrants where the function has the given sign** (ASTC). Two quadrants per period for sin/cos; tan covers both in one π -period.

(3) **Write the general solution.** For sin/cos: α and $\pi - \alpha$ (or $2\pi - \alpha$, depending), each $+2\pi n$. For tan: $\alpha + \pi n$.

 **Pro tip — The most common mistake:** After finding $\arcsin k = \alpha$, students stop and write $x = \alpha$. This loses half the solutions. Always ask: "*Where else on the unit circle does sine have this value?*" The answer is always the mirror angle across the y -axis: $\pi - \alpha$ (for sine) or $2\pi - \alpha$ (for cosine in QIV).

Example 7: Quadratic Equations — t -Substitution

$$2 \cos^2 x - \cos x - 1 = 0:$$

(1) Let $t = \cos x$, $t \in [-1, 1]$. Then $2t^2 - t - 1 = 0$.

(2) Factor: $(2t + 1)(t - 1) = 0$. $t = 1$ or $t = -\frac{1}{2}$.

(3) $\cos x = 1 \rightarrow x = 2n\pi$. $\cos x = -\frac{1}{2} \rightarrow x = \frac{2\pi}{3} + 2n\pi$ or $\frac{4\pi}{3} + 2n\pi$.

$$2 \sin^2 x + 3 \sin x + 1 = 0:$$

(1) $t = \sin x$, $t \in [-1, 1]$: $2t^2 + 3t + 1 = 0 \rightarrow (2t + 1)(t + 1) = 0$.

(2) $t = -\frac{1}{2}$ or $t = -1$.

(3) $\sin x = -\frac{1}{2} \rightarrow x = \frac{7\pi}{6} + 2n\pi$ or $\frac{11\pi}{6} + 2n\pi$.

$\sin x = -1 \rightarrow x = \frac{3\pi}{2} + 2n\pi$.

$$3 \tan^2 x - 1 = 0:$$

(1) $t = \tan x$: $3t^2 - 1 = 0 \rightarrow t = \pm \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}$.

(2) $\tan x = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{3} \rightarrow x = \frac{\pi}{6} + n\pi$. $\tan x = -\frac{\sqrt{3}}{3} \rightarrow x = -\frac{\pi}{6} + n\pi$.

Always check $t \in [-1, 1]$ for sin/cos. Roots outside are invalid. For tan, t can be any real

number.

Geometric insight: t -substitution flattens the trig equation into algebra. Each valid $t \in [-1, 1]$ (sin/cos) corresponds to a horizontal line intersecting the unit circle at two points (except $t = \pm 1$, which touches tangentially).

Method — Quadratic trig equations in 3 steps:

- (1) **Let $t = \sin x$ (or $\cos x, \tan x$).** Replace every trig term. For sin/cos, $t \in [-1, 1]$.
- (2) **Solve the quadratic.** Factor or use the formula. Discard $t \notin [-1, 1]$ for sin/cos.
- (3) **Solve each t -equation** using the method from Example 6.

Example 8: Mixed-Angle Equations — Unify All Angles

$\sin 2x = \cos x$:

- (1) Replace $\sin 2x = 2 \sin x \cos x$: $2 \sin x \cos x = \cos x$.
- (2) Bring to one side: $2 \sin x \cos x - \cos x = 0 \rightarrow \cos x(2 \sin x - 1) = 0$.
- (3) $\cos x = 0 \rightarrow x = \frac{\pi}{2} + n\pi$.
 $\sin x = \frac{1}{2} \rightarrow x = \frac{\pi}{6} + 2n\pi$ or $\frac{5\pi}{6} + 2n\pi$.

$\cos 2x + \cos x = 0$:

- (1) Use $\cos 2x = 2 \cos^2 x - 1$: $2 \cos^2 x - 1 + \cos x = 0 \rightarrow 2 \cos^2 x + \cos x - 1 = 0$.
- (2) $t = \cos x$: $(2t - 1)(t + 1) = 0 \rightarrow t = \frac{1}{2}, -1$.
- (3) $\cos x = \frac{1}{2} \rightarrow x = \pm \frac{\pi}{3} + 2n\pi$. $\cos x = -1 \rightarrow x = \pi + 2n\pi$.

When sum-to-product is better: $\sin 5x = \sin 3x$:

- (1) $\sin 5x - \sin 3x = 0 \rightarrow 2 \cos 4x \sin x = 0$.

$$(2) \cos 4x = 0 \rightarrow 4x = \frac{\pi}{2} + n\pi \rightarrow x = \frac{\pi}{8} + \frac{n\pi}{4}.$$

$$\sin x = 0 \rightarrow x = n\pi.$$

Method — Mixed-angle equations in 3 steps:

(1) **Pick a strategy.** Different functions of same angle $\rightarrow$ factor. Different angles $\rightarrow$ unify via double/triple-angle or sum-to-product.

(2) **Convert everything to the same angle.** Replace $2x$, $3x$ with expressions in x .

(3) **Factor if possible, otherwise t -substitute.** Solve the resulting equation as in Examples 6-7.

Example 9: Mixed sin/cos — Factor or Harmonic-Add

Case 1 — Factorable: $\sin x = \cos x$:

Check $\cos x = 0$: no solution here ($\sin \frac{\pi}{2} = 1 \neq 0$). Divide by $\cos x$: $\tan x = 1 \rightarrow x = \frac{\pi}{4} + n\pi$.

Case 2 — Harmonic addition: $\sin x + \sqrt{3} \cos x = 1$:

$$(1) R = \sqrt{1 + 3} = 2, \phi = \arctan \frac{\sqrt{3}}{1} = \frac{\pi}{3}.$$

$$(2) 2 \sin(x + \frac{\pi}{3}) = 1 \rightarrow \sin(x + \frac{\pi}{3}) = \frac{1}{2}.$$

$$(3) x + \frac{\pi}{3} = \frac{\pi}{6} + 2n\pi \text{ or } \frac{5\pi}{6} + 2n\pi.$$

$$x = -\frac{\pi}{6} + 2n\pi \text{ or } x = \frac{\pi}{2} + 2n\pi.$$

Case 3 — $3 \cos x - 4 \sin x = 2$:

$$(1) R = \sqrt{9 + 16} = 5. \phi = \arctan \frac{3}{-4} = \pi - \arctan \frac{3}{4} \text{ (since } a < 0 \text{)}.$$

Rewrite: $5 \cos(x - \phi')$ where $\phi' = \arctan \frac{4}{3}$.

$$(2) 5 \cos(x - \phi') = 2 \rightarrow \cos(x - \phi') = \frac{2}{5}.$$

$$(3) x - \phi' = \pm \arccos \frac{2}{5} + 2n\pi \rightarrow x = \phi' \pm \arccos \frac{2}{5} + 2n\pi.$$

Geometric insight: $a \sin x + b \cos x = c$ is the intersection of a shifted sine wave with horizontal line $y = c$. If $|c| > R$, no solution. If $|c| = R$, one solution per period. If $|c| < R$, two solutions.

Example 10: Weierstrass $t = \tan \frac{x}{2}$ — The Universal Solver

$t = \tan \frac{x}{2}$ converts any rational trig equation into a rational equation in t :

$$\sin x = \frac{2t}{1+t^2}, \cos x = \frac{1-t^2}{1+t^2}, \tan x = \frac{2t}{1-t^2}.$$

Solve $\sin x + \cos x = 1$:

(1) Substitute: $\frac{2t}{1+t^2} + \frac{1-t^2}{1+t^2} = 1$.

(2) Clear $1 + t^2$ (never zero): $2t + 1 - t^2 = 1 + t^2 \rightarrow 2t^2 - 2t = 0 \rightarrow 2t(t - 1) = 0$.

(3) $t = 0 \rightarrow \tan \frac{x}{2} = 0 \rightarrow x = 2n\pi$.

$t = 1 \rightarrow \tan \frac{x}{2} = 1 \rightarrow x = \frac{\pi}{2} + 2n\pi$.

Solve $\frac{1}{\sin x} = 2$ on $[0, 2\pi]$:

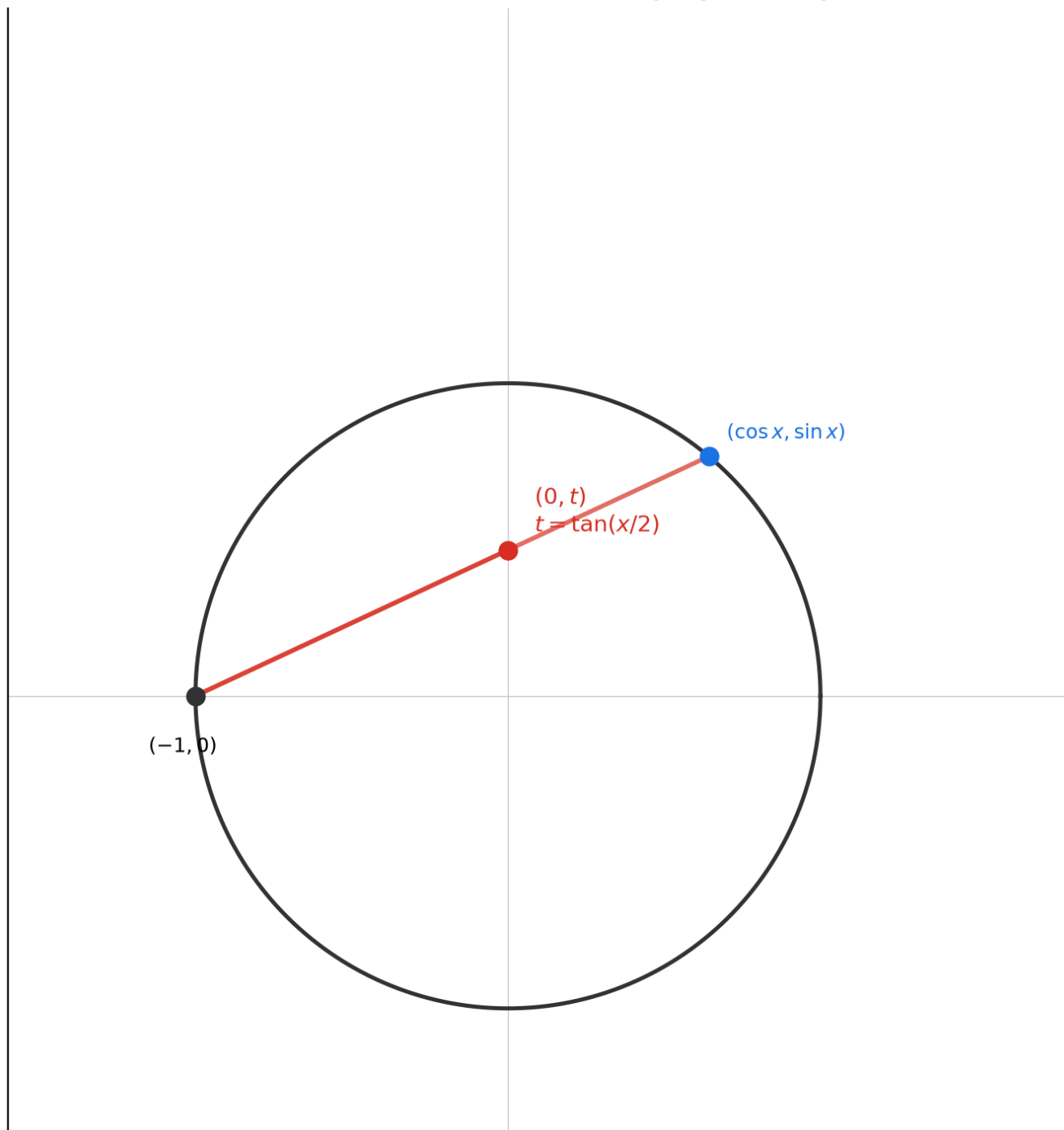
(1) Using Weierstrass: $\frac{1+t^2}{2t} = 2 \rightarrow 1 + t^2 = 4t \rightarrow t^2 - 4t + 1 = 0$.

(2) $t = 2 \pm \sqrt{3}$.

(3) $t = 2 + \sqrt{3} \rightarrow \tan \frac{x}{2} = 2 + \sqrt{3} \rightarrow \frac{x}{2} = \frac{5\pi}{12} \rightarrow x = \frac{5\pi}{6}$.

$t = 2 - \sqrt{3} \rightarrow \frac{x}{2} = \frac{\pi}{12} \rightarrow x = \frac{\pi}{6}$.

Weierstrass: $t = \tan(x/2)$ — Stereographic Projection



Geometric insight: $t = \tan \frac{x}{2}$ maps the unit circle (minus $(-1, 0)$) one-to-one onto the real line. A line from $(-1, 0)$ through $(\cos x, \sin x)$ hits the y -axis at $(0, t)$. This is stereographic projection.

Method — Weierstrass in 3 steps:

(1) **Replace all trig terms** with their t -forms. $t = \tan \frac{x}{2}$.

(2) **Clear denominators** by multiplying through by $1 + t^2$. The result is a polynomial in t .

(3) **Solve for t , then convert back.** $t = k \rightarrow \frac{x}{2} = \arctan k + n\pi \rightarrow x = 2 \arctan k + 2n\pi$.

 **Pro tip — When Weierstrass is overkill:** Don't use $t = \tan(x/2)$ for $\sin x = \cos x$ — just divide by $\cos x$ to get $\tan x = 1$. Don't use it for $\sin x = \frac{1}{2}$ — just read the unit circle. Weierstrass is your **last resort** for messy rational equations like $\frac{1+\sin x}{\cos x} = 3$. If a simpler method (factoring, harmonic addition, basic solving) works, use that instead.

Example 11: Trigonometric Inequalities — The Unit Circle Method

$\sin x > \frac{1}{2}$ on $[0, 2\pi]$:

(1) $\sin x = \frac{1}{2}$ at $x = \frac{\pi}{6}, \frac{5\pi}{6}$.

(2) On the unit circle, $\sin x = y$ -coordinate. $\sin x > \frac{1}{2} \rightarrow$ point is above $y = \frac{1}{2}$.

(3) Answer: $x \in (\frac{\pi}{6}, \frac{5\pi}{6})$. General: $x \in (\frac{\pi}{6} + 2n\pi, \frac{5\pi}{6} + 2n\pi)$.

$\cos x \leq -\frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}$ on $[0, 2\pi]$:

(1) $\cos x = -\frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}$ at $x = \frac{3\pi}{4}, \frac{5\pi}{4}$.

(2) $\cos x \leq -\frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} \rightarrow x$ -coordinate is at or left of $-\frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}$. On the unit circle: the left arc through π .

(3) Answer: $x \in [\frac{3\pi}{4}, \frac{5\pi}{4}]$.

$\tan x > 1$ on $[0, 2\pi]$:

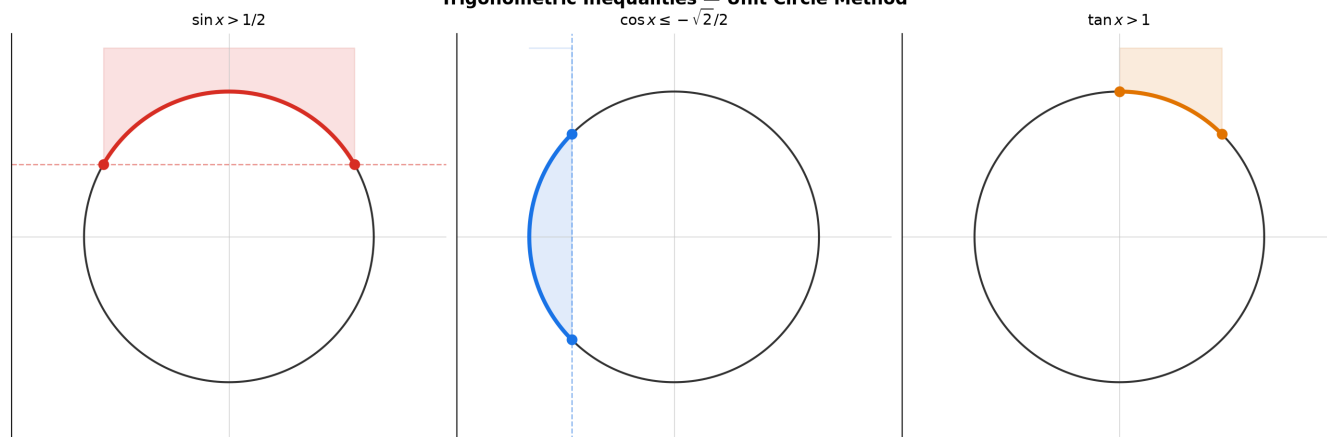
(1) $\tan x = 1$ at $\frac{\pi}{4}, \frac{5\pi}{4}$.

(2) $\tan x > 1 \rightarrow$ slope steeper than 45° . Ray between 45° and 90° (QI) or 225° to 270° (QIII).

(3) $x \in (\frac{\pi}{4}, \frac{\pi}{2}) \cup (\frac{5\pi}{4}, \frac{3\pi}{2})$.

General: $x \in (\frac{\pi}{4} + n\pi, \frac{\pi}{2} + n\pi)$.

Trigonometric Inequalities — Unit Circle Method



Example 12: Quadratic Trig Inequalities

$2 \sin^2 x - \sin x - 1 < 0$ on $[0, 2\pi]$:

(1) $t = \sin x, t \in [-1, 1]$. $(2t + 1)(t - 1) < 0$. Roots: $t = -\frac{1}{2}, 1$.

(2) Sign chart: $t \in (-\frac{1}{2}, 1)$ makes the product negative. So $-\frac{1}{2} < \sin x < 1$.

(3) $-\frac{1}{2} < \sin x$ and $\sin x < 1$.

$\sin x > -\frac{1}{2}$: $x \in [0, \frac{7\pi}{6}) \cup (\frac{11\pi}{6}, 2\pi]$.

$\sin x < 1$: all x except $\frac{\pi}{2}$.

Intersection: $x \in [0, \frac{\pi}{2}) \cup (\frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{7\pi}{6}) \cup (\frac{11\pi}{6}, 2\pi]$.

Method — Quadratic trig inequalities in 3 steps:

(1) **t -substitute.** Solve the quadratic inequality algebraically to get a t -range.

(2) **Translate to trig inequalities.** e.g., $-\frac{1}{2} < t < 1 \rightarrow -\frac{1}{2} < \sin x < 1$.

(3) **Solve on the unit circle and intersect arcs.**



Do's and Don'ts — Equations & Inequalities:



Do

Check $t \in [-1, 1]$ after solving a quadratic



Don't

Don't blindly accept all t -roots.

✓ Do	✗ Don't
in $\sin x$ or $\cos x$. Discard $t = -2$ or $t = 1.5$ — impossible.	$\sin x = -2$ has no solution.
Find both solutions per period for $\sin/\cos$. $\sin x = \frac{1}{2} \rightarrow x = \frac{\pi}{6}$ AND $\frac{5\pi}{6}$.	Don't stop at just $\arcsin(\frac{1}{2}) = \frac{\pi}{6}$. $\arcsin$ only gives the Q1 angle.
Factor, don't divide when terms share a trig factor. $\sin x \cos x = \cos x \rightarrow \cos x(\sin x - 1) = 0$.	Don't divide by $\cos x$. You'll lose the solutions where $\cos x = 0$.
Draw the unit circle for inequalities. Shade the arc where $\sin x > k$ (above $y = k$) or $\cos x < k$ (left of $x = k$).	Don't memorize inequality ranges. One sign error and the interval flips. The circle never lies.
Check endpoints manually for $\leq$ or $\geq$ inequalities. At the boundary, equality holds — include it.	Don't assume open/closed from memory. $\sin x \geq \frac{1}{2}$ includes $\frac{\pi}{6}$ and $\frac{5\pi}{6}$; $\sin x > \frac{1}{2}$ excludes them.
Verify by plugging back one solution from each family into the original equation, especially after squaring or dividing.	Don't skip verification after squaring both sides — squaring can introduce extraneous solutions.
Use period shortcuts: $\tan x = k \rightarrow x = \arctan k + n\pi$ (one formula covers both quadrants because period is π).	Don't write two separate families for $\tan$ — it's redundant. $\tan x = 1 \rightarrow x = \frac{\pi}{4} + n\pi$ already covers $\frac{5\pi}{4}$.

Example 13: Law of Sines and Law of Cosines

Law of Sines: $\frac{a}{\sin A} = \frac{b}{\sin B} = \frac{c}{\sin C} = 2R$.

Use when given AAS or ASA (two angles + one side).

Find b when $a = 10$, $A = 30^\circ$, $B = 45^\circ$:

$$b = a \frac{\sin B}{\sin A} = 10 \frac{\sin 45^\circ}{\sin 30^\circ} = 10 \frac{\sqrt{2}/2}{1/2} = 10\sqrt{2}.$$

Ambiguous case (SSA): $a = 5, b = 8, A = 30^\circ$.

$\sin B = \frac{8 \sin 30^\circ}{5} = 0.8 \rightarrow B \approx 53.1^\circ$ or 126.9° . Two possible triangles.

Law of Cosines: $c^2 = a^2 + b^2 - 2ab \cos C$.

Find side c when $a = 5, b = 7, C = 60^\circ$:

$$c^2 = 25 + 49 - 2(5)(7)\frac{1}{2} = 74 - 35 = 39 \rightarrow c = \sqrt{39}.$$

Find angle A in 3-4-5 triangle: $\cos A = \frac{4^2 + 5^2 - 3^2}{2 \cdot 4 \cdot 5} = \frac{16 + 25 - 9}{40} = \frac{4}{5} \rightarrow A \approx 36.87^\circ$.

Triangle area:

$\frac{1}{2}ab \sin C$ (two sides + included angle). $a = 5, b = 8, C = 30^\circ \rightarrow \frac{1}{2} \cdot 5 \cdot 8 \cdot \frac{1}{2} = 10$.

Heron: $s = \frac{a+b+c}{2}$, $\text{Area} = \sqrt{s(s-a)(s-b)(s-c)}$.



Pro tip — The ambiguous SSA case: Given two sides and a non-included angle, always check if $\sin B = \frac{b \sin A}{a} \leq 1$. If $\sin B = 1$, exactly one right triangle. If $\sin B < 1$, there may be two triangles (B acute or obtuse) or one (B must be acute because $a \geq b$). Draw it — don't guess.

Up to here: 6 equation types (basic, quadratic, mixed-angle, mixed-function, Weierstrass, inverse trig) + inequalities + triangles. Each type has a clear 3-step method.

Part C: College-Level Techniques

Example 14: Euler's Formula — Every Identity from One Equation

$$e^{i\theta} = \cos \theta + i \sin \theta.$$

Deriving the sum formulas: $e^{i(A+B)} = e^{iA}e^{iB}$.

$$(\cos A + i \sin A)(\cos B + i \sin B) = (\cos A \cos B - \sin A \sin B) + i(\sin A \cos B + \cos A \sin B).$$

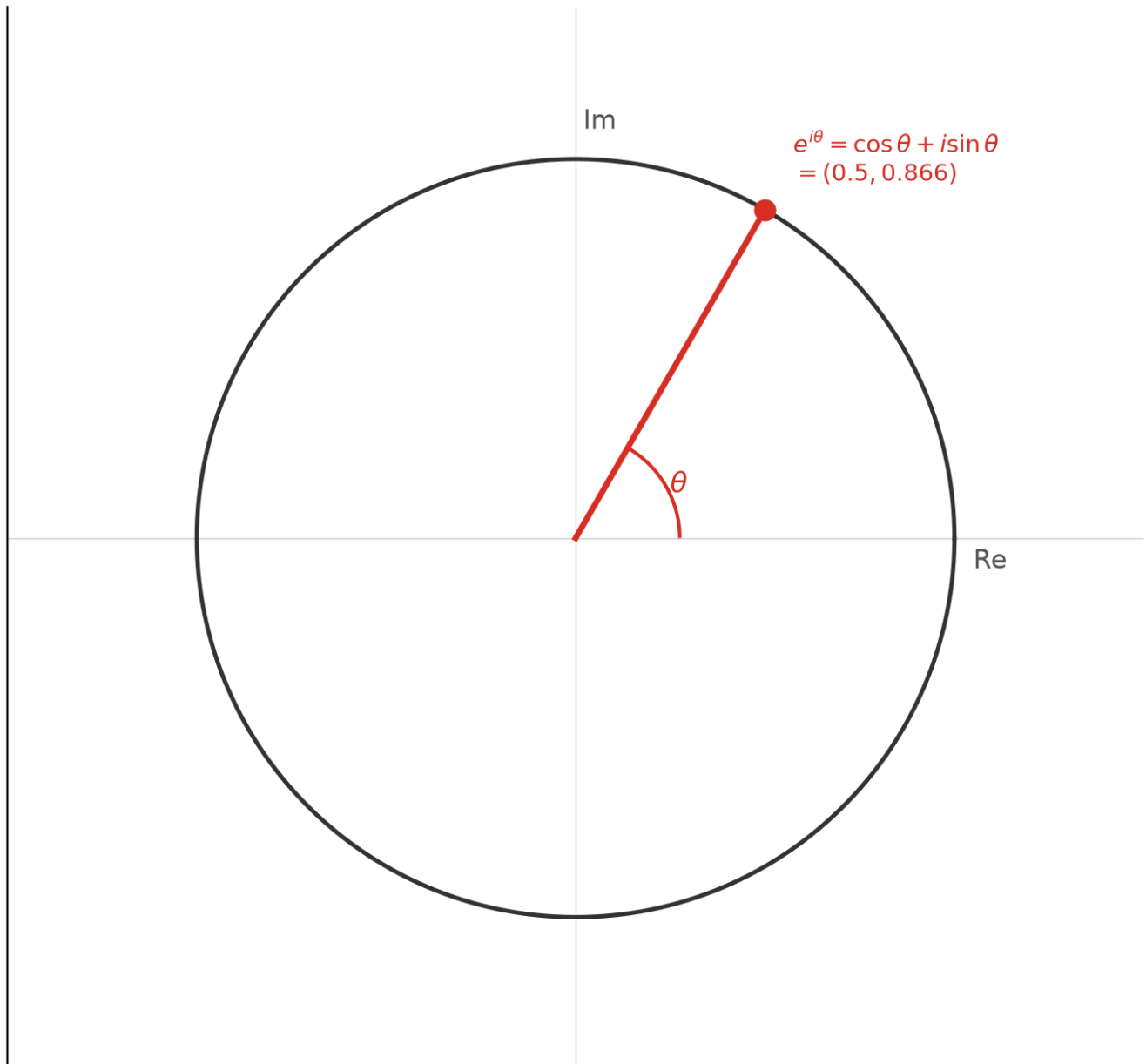
Equate with $\cos(A+B) + i \sin(A+B) \rightarrow$ both sum formulas at once.

De Moivre: $(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)^n = \cos(n\theta) + i \sin(n\theta)$.

Compute $\cos 3\theta$ via De Moivre: Expand $(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)^3 = \cos^3 \theta + 3i \cos^2 \theta \sin \theta - 3 \cos \theta \sin^2 \theta - i \sin^3 \theta$.

Real part: $\cos^3 \theta - 3 \cos \theta (1 - \cos^2 \theta) = 4 \cos^3 \theta - 3 \cos \theta = \cos 3\theta$.

Euler's Formula: $e^{i\theta} = \cos \theta + i \sin \theta$



Geometric insight: Multiplication by $e^{i\theta}$ rotates a complex number by θ . Euler's formula turns trig into exponent arithmetic.

Example 15: Chebyshev Polynomials — Cosines as Polynomials

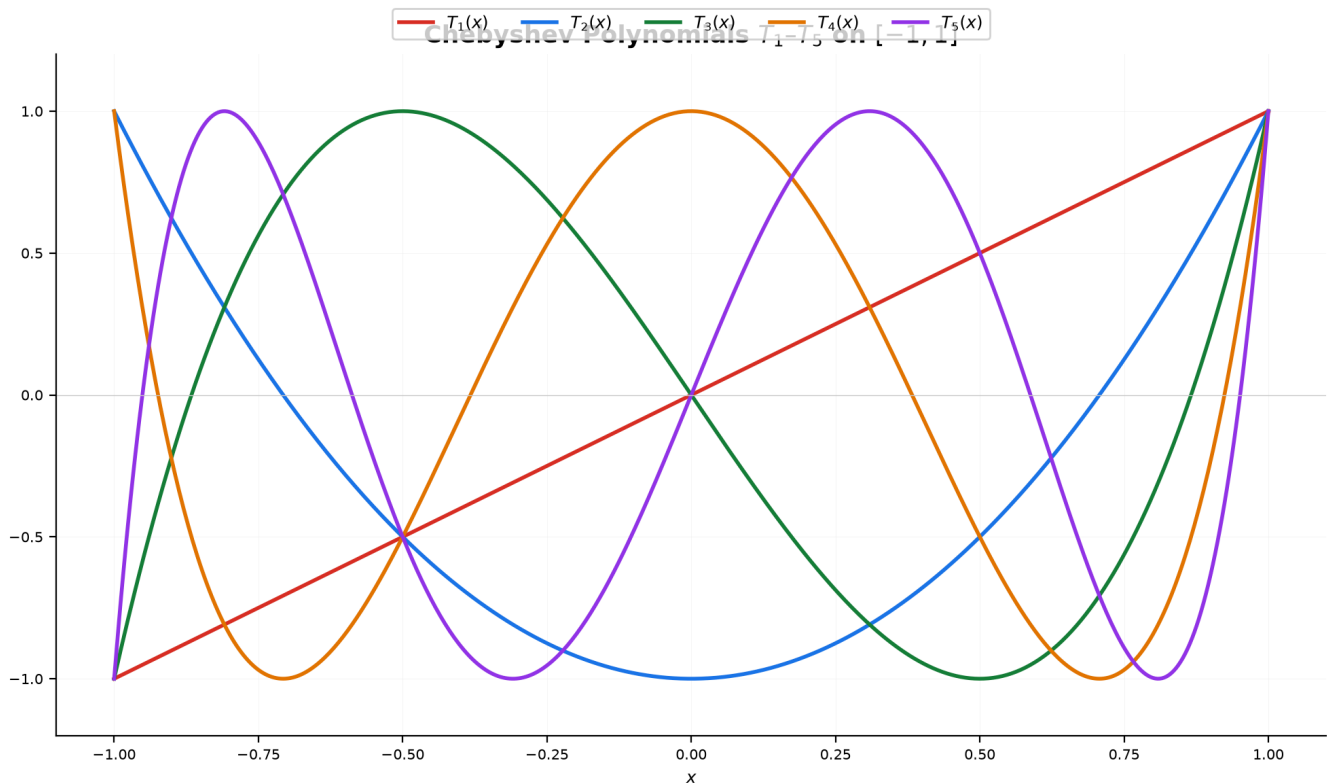
$$T_n(\cos \theta) = \cos(n\theta).$$

$$T_0(x) = 1, T_1(x) = x, T_2(x) = 2x^2 - 1, T_3(x) = 4x^3 - 3x, T_4(x) = 8x^4 - 8x^2 + 1, \\ T_5(x) = 16x^5 - 20x^3 + 5x.$$

$$\text{Recurrence: } T_{n+1}(x) = 2xT_n(x) - T_{n-1}(x).$$

Solve $\cos 3\theta = \frac{1}{2}$ **via Chebyshev:** $x = \cos \theta, T_3(x) = 4x^3 - 3x = \frac{1}{2} \rightarrow 8x^3 - 6x - 1 = 0$.

Roots: $x = \cos \frac{\pi}{9}, \cos \frac{7\pi}{9}, \cos \frac{13\pi}{9}$.



Geometric insight: Chebyshev polynomials oscillate between -1 and 1 with $n + 1$ equally spaced extrema on $[-1, 1]$. This equal-ripple property makes them optimal for approximation theory.

Example 16: Cubic Equations via Trigonometry

For $x^3 + px + q = 0$ with 3 real roots (casus irreducibilis):

Set $x = 2\sqrt{-\frac{p}{3}} \cos \theta$ where $\cos 3\theta = \frac{3q}{2p} \sqrt{-\frac{3}{p}}$.

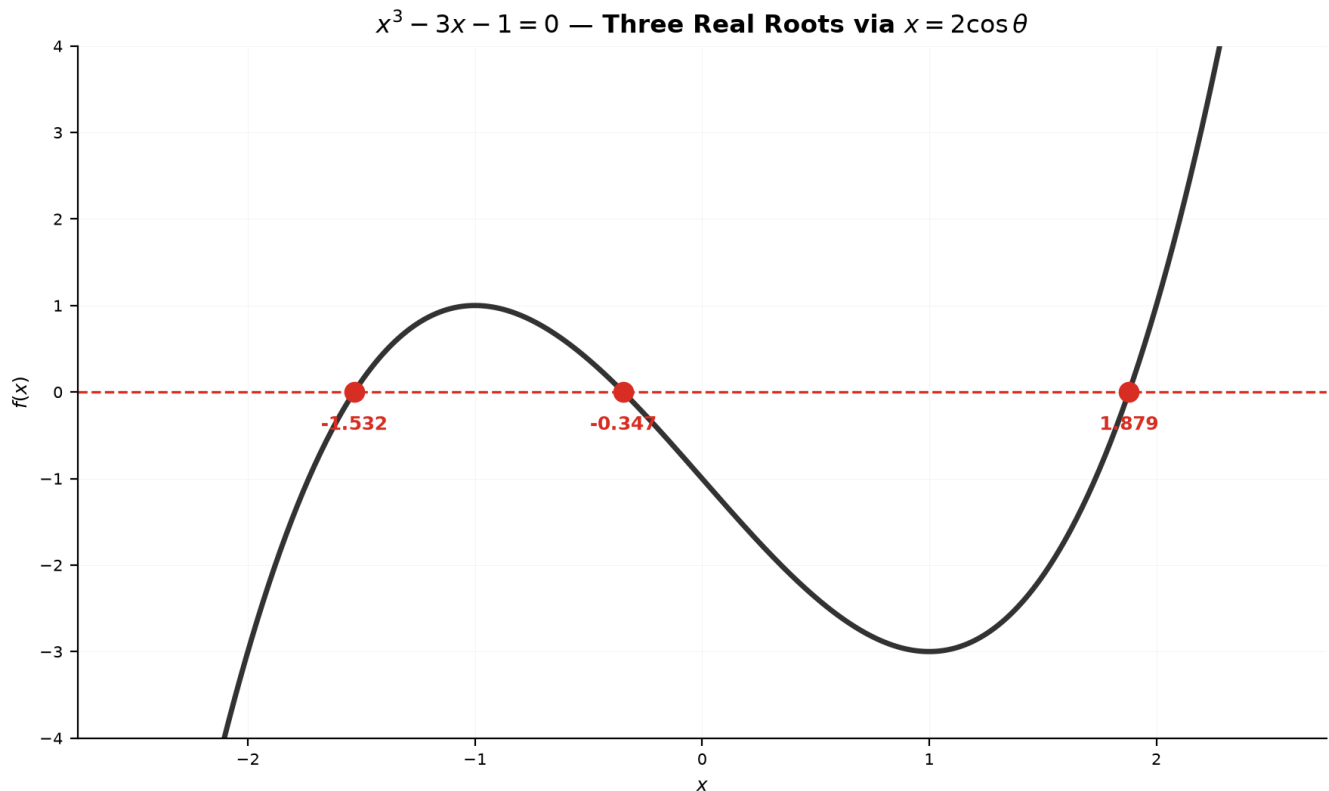
Solve $x^3 - 3x - 1 = 0$:

(1) $p = -3, q = -1. x = 2 \cos \theta.$

(2) $\cos 3\theta = \frac{3(-1)}{2(-3)} \sqrt{-\frac{3}{-3}} = \frac{1}{2}.$

(3) $3\theta = \frac{\pi}{3}, \frac{7\pi}{3}, \frac{13\pi}{3} \rightarrow \theta = \frac{\pi}{9}, \frac{7\pi}{9}, \frac{13\pi}{9}.$

Roots: $2 \cos \frac{\pi}{9} \approx 1.879, 2 \cos \frac{7\pi}{9} \approx -1.532, 2 \cos \frac{13\pi}{9} \approx -0.347.$



Geometric insight: The identity $4 \cos^3 \theta - 3 \cos \theta = \cos 3\theta$ turns the cubic into $\cos 3\theta = c$. The three roots come from three angles in $[0, \pi]$ whose triple has the same cosine.

Example 17: Viete's Formula — Infinite Product for π

$$\frac{2}{\pi} = \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{2+\sqrt{2}}}{2} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{2+\sqrt{2+\sqrt{2}}}}{2} \dots$$

Derivation: Repeatedly apply the half-angle formula $\cos \frac{\theta}{2} = \sqrt{\frac{1+\cos \theta}{2}}$ starting from $\theta = \frac{\pi}{2}$.

$$\cos \frac{\pi}{4} = \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} \cdot \cos \frac{\pi}{8} = \frac{\sqrt{2+\sqrt{2}}}{2} \cdot \cos \frac{\pi}{16} = \frac{\sqrt{2+\sqrt{2+\sqrt{2}}}}{2}.$$

The identity $\frac{\sin x}{x} = \cos \frac{x}{2} \cos \frac{x}{4} \cos \frac{x}{8} \dots$ with $x = \frac{\pi}{2}$ gives $\frac{2}{\pi}$ as the infinite product.

Example 18: Trigonometric Integrals Preview

Using $\sin^2 \theta = \frac{1-\cos 2\theta}{2}$:

$$\int \sin^2 x \, dx = \int \frac{1-\cos 2x}{2} \, dx = \frac{x}{2} - \frac{\sin 2x}{4} + C$$

$$\int \cos^2 x \, dx = \frac{x}{2} + \frac{\sin 2x}{4} + C$$

$$\int_0^\pi \sin^2 x \, dx = \left[\frac{x}{2} - \frac{\sin 2x}{4} \right]_0^\pi = \frac{\pi}{2}$$

Cubic: $\int \sin^3 x \, dx = \int \frac{3 \sin x - \sin 3x}{4} \, dx = -\frac{3 \cos x}{4} + \frac{\cos 3x}{12} + C$

Geometric insight: Every trig integral depends on the identities from Part A. Power-reduction turns unintegrable squares into integrable first powers.

Example 19: Generating Pythagorean Triples

Via the Weierstrass parametrization: every rational point (x, y) on $x^2 + y^2 = 1$ has $x = \frac{1-t^2}{1+t^2}$, $y = \frac{2t}{1+t^2}$ for rational t .

Let $t = \frac{p}{q}$: then $(q^2 - p^2, 2pq, q^2 + p^2)$ is a Pythagorean triple.

p	q	triple
1	2	3, 4, 5
2	3	5, 12, 13
1	4	8, 15, 17
3	4	7, 24, 25

Geometric insight: Rational points on the unit circle = Pythagorean triples. The Weierstrass $t = \tan \frac{\theta}{2}$ parametrizes them all.

Example 20: Fourier Series — Decomposing Waves

Any 2π -periodic $f(x) = \frac{a_0}{2} + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} (a_n \cos nx + b_n \sin nx)$.

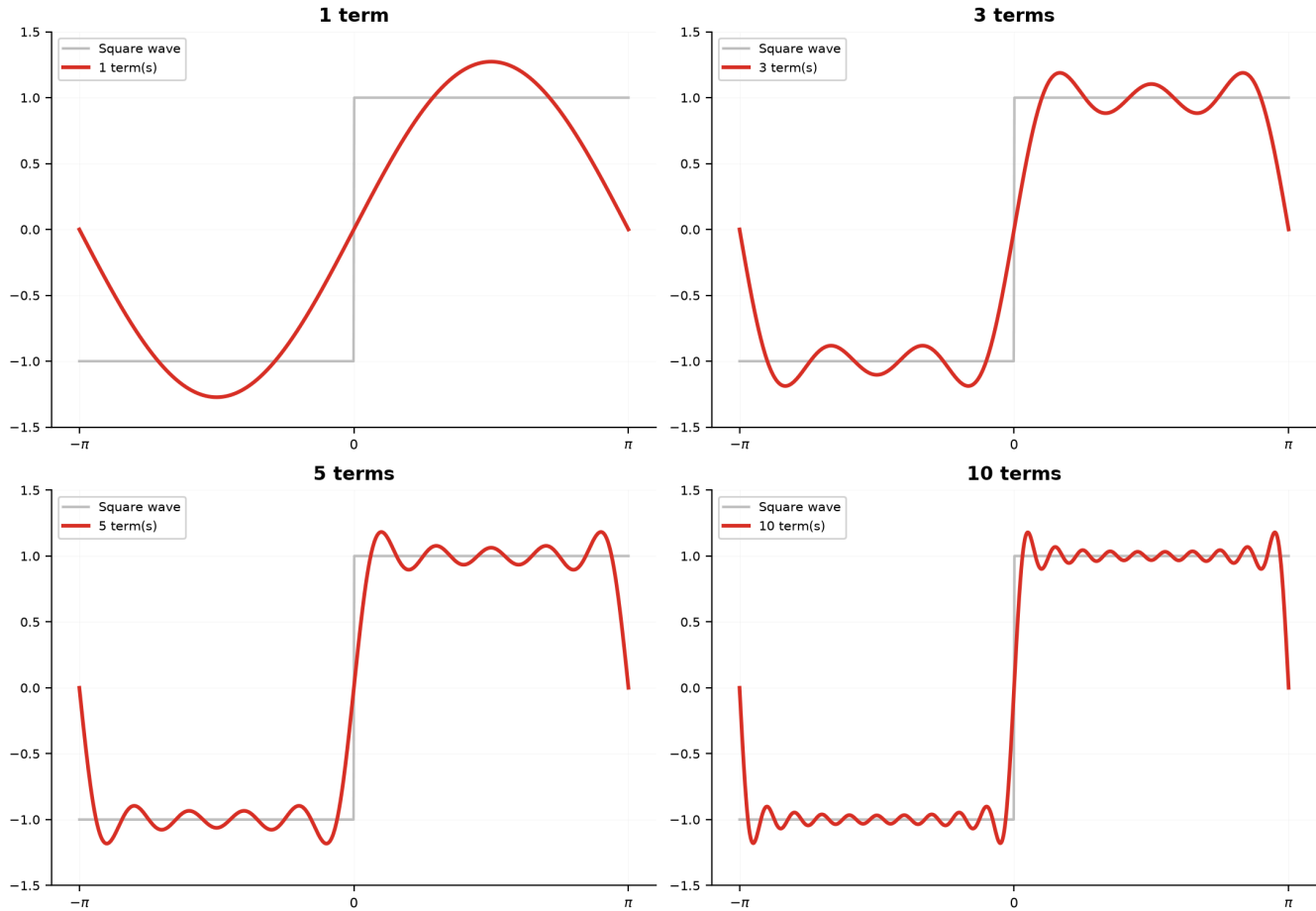
Square wave $f(x) = \begin{cases} 1 & 0 < x < \pi \\ -1 & -\pi < x < 0 \end{cases}$:

$$f(x) = \frac{4}{\pi} \left(\sin x + \frac{\sin 3x}{3} + \frac{\sin 5x}{5} + \dots \right).$$

The identities from Part A make computing a_n, b_n possible:

$$a_n = \frac{1}{\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} f(x) \cos nx \, dx. \quad b_n = \frac{1}{\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} f(x) \sin nx \, dx.$$

Fourier Series: Square Wave $\frac{4}{\pi}(\sin x + \frac{\sin 3x}{3} + \frac{\sin 5x}{5} + \dots)$



Geometric insight: Fourier's discovery (1807): ANY periodic wave is built from pure sines and cosines. The identities from this session are the alphabet; Fourier series is the language.

Decision Tree — Trig Equations

You encounter a trigonometric equation:

- |— (1) Single trig type, same angle? ($\sin x = k$, $2\cos^2 x - \cos x - 1 = 0$)
 - | |— $t = \sin x$ (or $\cos x$). Solve polynomial. Check $t \in [-1, 1]$.
- |— (2) Different angles? ($\sin 2x = \cos x$)
 - | |— Unify via double/triple-angle or sum-to-product.
- |— (3) sin and cos mixed?
 - | |— Factorable $\rightarrow$ set each factor = 0.
 - | |— $a \sin x + b \cos x = c \rightarrow$ harmonic addition.
 - | |— Else $\rightarrow$ Weierstrass $t = \tan(x/2)$.
- |— (4) Inverse trig? ($2\arcsin x = \arccos x$)
 - | |— Apply trig to both sides, check ranges.
- |— (5) Inequality?
 - | |— $\sin x > k$ / $\cos x < k \rightarrow$ unit circle arcs.
 - | |— Quadratic $\rightarrow$ t-sub, solve inequality, map back.

Decision Tree — Choosing an Identity

- |— Sum/diff inside trig $\rightarrow$ sum/difference formulas
 - |— Multiple angle (2θ , 3θ , $\theta/2$) $\rightarrow$ double/half/triple-angle
 - |— $a \sin x + b \cos x \rightarrow$ harmonic addition $\rightarrow R \sin(x+\phi)$
 - |— Product of trigs $\rightarrow$ product-to-sum
 - |— Sum of trigs $\rightarrow$ sum-to-product
 - |— $\sin^2 \theta$ or $\cos^2 \theta \rightarrow$ power-reduction
 - |— $\cos(n\theta)$ as polynomial $\rightarrow$ Chebyshev T_n
-

Common Mistakes

Mistake 1: $\cos(A + B) = \cos A + \cos B$

Wrong path: $\cos(A + B) = \cos A + \cos B$.

Why wrong: Cosine does not distribute. $\cos 90^\circ = \cos(60^\circ + 30^\circ) \neq \frac{1}{2} + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$.

Right path: $\cos(A + B) = \cos A \cos B - \sin A \sin B$.

Mistake 2: Dividing by $\cos x$ without checking $\cos x = 0$

Wrong path: $\sin x = \cos x \rightarrow$ divide by $\cos x \rightarrow \tan x = 1$.

Why wrong: If $\cos x = 0$, division is illegal. Solutions might be lost.

Right path: Check $\cos x = 0$ first. If no solution, then divide safely.

Mistake 3: Only one solution per period for $\sin/\cos$

Wrong path: $\sin x = \frac{1}{2} \rightarrow x = \frac{\pi}{6} + 2n\pi$.

Why wrong: $\sin x = \frac{1}{2}$ has TWO solutions per period: $\frac{\pi}{6}$ (QI) and $\frac{5\pi}{6}$ (QII).

Right path: Find both quadrant solutions, add $2\pi n$ to each.

Mistake 4: Mismatching side and angle in Law of Sines

Wrong path: $\frac{a}{\sin B}$.

Why wrong: Side a is opposite angle A .

Right path: $\frac{a}{\sin A} = \frac{b}{\sin B} = \frac{c}{\sin C}$. Letters must match.

Mistake 5: Forgetting $t \in [-1, 1]$ when substituting sin/cos

Wrong path: $2 \sin^2 x + 3 \sin x + 1 = 0 \rightarrow t = -2$ or $t = -\frac{1}{2} \rightarrow$ both valid.

Why wrong: $t = \sin x$ must be in $[-1, 1]$. $t = -2$ is impossible.

Right path: After solving the quadratic, filter $t \in [-1, 1]$ before converting back.

What We Just Did

Building on 11A (radians, unit circle, six graphs, inverse trig):

(1) Identity toolkit (5 families):

Sum/difference (6 formulas). Double/half/triple angle.

Harmonic addition: $a \sin x + b \cos x \rightarrow R \sin(x+\phi)$, $R = \sqrt{a^2+b^2}$.

Product $\leftrightarrow$ sum (6 formulas). Power-reduction: $\sin^2\theta = (1-\cos 2\theta)/2$.

(2) Equation solving (6 types, each with 3-step method):

Basic (Example 6). Quadratic/t-sub (7). Mixed-angle (8).

Mixed-function-factor or harmonic-add (9). Weierstrass (10).

Inverse trig equations.

(3) Inequalities (Examples 11-12):

Unit circle method: boundary angles $\rightarrow$ arcs.

Quadratic: t-sub $\rightarrow$ algebraic inequality $\rightarrow$ map back to arcs.

(4) Triangles: Law of Sines, Law of Cosines, area (Example 13).

(5) College techniques:

Euler: $e^{i\theta} = \cos \theta + i \sin \theta \rightarrow$ all identities from exponent rules.

De Moivre. Roots of unity.

Chebyshev: $T_n(\cos \theta) = \cos(n\theta)$.

Cubic via trig: $x = 2\sqrt{-p/3} \cos \theta$ solves casus irreducibilis.

Viète's infinite product for π .

Trig integrals: power-reduction in action.

Pythagorean triples via rational parametrization.

Fourier series: any wave = Σ sines + cosines.

Practice 1

Use the sum formula to compute $\sin 105^\circ$ exactly. Verify using $\sin 105^\circ = \sin(180^\circ - 75^\circ) = \sin 75^\circ$.

$\rightarrow$ Reference: **Example 1**

Solutions: [Solutions](#)

Practice 2

Given $\sin \theta = \frac{5}{13}$ with θ in QII, find $\sin 2\theta$, $\cos 2\theta$, and $\tan 2\theta$.

→ Reference: **Example 2**

Solutions: [Solutions](#)

Practice 3

Write $12 \sin x + 5 \cos x$ in the form $R \sin(x + \phi)$. Find the maximum value and the smallest positive x where it occurs.

→ Reference: **Example 3**

Solutions: [Solutions](#)

Practice 4

Solve $2 \cos^2 x - 3 \cos x + 1 = 0$ for $x \in [0, 2\pi]$. List all solutions.

→ Reference: **Example 7**

Solutions: [Solutions](#)

Practice 5

Simplify $\sin 5x + \sin x$ using sum-to-product, then solve $\sin 5x + \sin x = 0$ on $[0, 2\pi]$.

→ Reference: **Example 4, 8**

Solutions: [Solutions](#)

Practice 6

Solve $\sin x \geq \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$ on $[0, 2\pi]$. Draw the unit circle and shade the solution arcs.

→ Reference: **Example 11**

Solutions: [Solutions](#)

Practice 7

Solve $2 \sin^2 x - \sin x - 1 < 0$ on $[0, 2\pi]$. Give your answer in interval notation.

→ Reference: **Example 12**

Solutions: [Solutions](#)

Practice 8

Triangle ABC : $a = 7$, $b = 10$, $c = 13$. Find all three angles and the area.

→ Reference: **Example 13**

Solutions: [Solutions](#)

Practice 9: Real Battle

Using Euler's formula, derive $\sin 4\theta$ and $\cos 4\theta$ by expanding $(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)^4$.

→ Reference: **Example 14**

Solutions: [Solutions](#)

Practice 10: Real Battle

(a) Solve $x^3 - 3x + 1 = 0$ using the trigonometric method. Give all three real roots as $2 \cos \alpha$.

(b) A sound wave is approximately $f(t) = \sin t + \frac{1}{3} \sin 3t + \frac{1}{5} \sin 5t$. Use harmonic addition identities to find all $t \in [0, 2\pi]$ where $f(t) = 1$.

→ Reference: **Example 16, 20**

Solutions: [Solutions](#)

Basic Algebra Drill — Identities and Equations (10 Problems)

Pure fluency. Instant recall and rapid computation.

D1. Compute $\sin 75^\circ$ using $\sin(45^\circ + 30^\circ)$.

D2. Compute $\cos 105^\circ$ using $\cos(60^\circ + 45^\circ)$.

D3. Compute $\tan 15^\circ$ using $\tan(45^\circ - 30^\circ)$.

D4. Given $\sin A = \frac{3}{5}$ (A in QI) and $\cos B = \frac{5}{13}$ (B in QI), find $\sin(A + B)$.

D5. Given $\cos \theta = -\frac{4}{5}$ (θ in QII), find $\cos 2\theta$.

D6. Write $\sin 3x \cos x$ as a sum of two sines (product-to-sum).

D7. Write $\sin 5x + \sin x$ as a product (sum-to-product).

D8. Compute $\arcsin\left(\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right)$ and $\arccos\left(-\frac{1}{2}\right)$.

D9. Compute $\sin\left(\arcsin \frac{3}{5} + \arccos \frac{5}{13}\right)$.

D10. Triangle ABC : $A = 40^\circ$, $B = 60^\circ$, $a = 8$. Find side b (Law of Sines).

Solutions: [Solutions](#)

Advanced Algebra Drill — Multi-Step Problems (10 Problems)

Chains 2–3 techniques. Covers all identities, equation types, and college-level material.

A1. Prove $\frac{\sin 2x}{1 + \cos 2x} = \tan x$. Then use it to simplify $\tan 15^\circ$.

A2. Solve $\cos 2x + 3 \sin x = 2$ for $x \in [0, 2\pi]$. (Hint: $\cos 2x = 1 - 2 \sin^2 x$.)

A3. Solve $\tan^2 x - (1 + \sqrt{3}) \tan x + \sqrt{3} = 0$ for $x \in [0, 2\pi]$.

A4. Solve $\cos 2x + \cos x < 0$ on $[0, 2\pi]$. (Use $\cos 2x = 2 \cos^2 x - 1$.)

A5. Simplify $\sin^4 \theta - \cos^4 \theta$ as a single trig function of 2θ . (Factor as difference of squares.)

A6. Compute $\cos 20^\circ \cdot \cos 40^\circ \cdot \cos 80^\circ$ exactly. (Multiply and divide by $\sin 20^\circ$.)

A7. Find all $x \in [0, 2\pi]$ such that $\sin 3x = \sin x$. Use sum-to-product.

A8. Derive $\cos 5\theta$ as a polynomial in $\cos \theta$ using Chebyshev: $T_5(x) = 2xT_4(x) - T_3(x)$.

A9. Generate the Pythagorean triple from $p = 2$, $q = 5$. Verify $a^2 + b^2 = c^2$.

A10. Compute the first three nonzero terms of the Fourier sine series for $f(x) = x$ on $(-\pi, \pi)$. ($b_n = \frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^\pi x \sin nx \, dx = \frac{2(-1)^{n+1}}{n}$.)

Solutions: [Solutions](#)

Today's Procedure

Step 1: Wield the identities – sum/difference. Double/half-angle. Harmonic addition:
 $a \sin x + b \cos x \rightarrow R \sin(x+\phi)$. Product $\leftrightarrow$ sum. Power-reduction.

Step 2: Solve equations – 6 types, each 3-step.

Basic: $\arcsin \rightarrow$ quadrants $\rightarrow +n \times \text{period}$.

Quadratic: t-sub $\rightarrow$ polynomial $\rightarrow$ convert back.

Mixed-angle: unify $\rightarrow$ solve.

Mixed-function: factor or harmonic-add.

Weierstrass: $t = \tan(x/2)$ universal.

Inverse trig: apply trig, check ranges.

Step 3: Inequalities – unit circle: boundary angles $\rightarrow$ shade arcs.

Step 4: Triangles – SAS/SSS $\rightarrow$ Law of Cosines. AAS/ASA $\rightarrow$ Law of Sines.

Step 5: College – Euler: $e^{i\theta} = \cos \theta + i \sin \theta$. De Moivre. Chebyshev.
Cubic via trig. Viète. Trig integrals. Fourier series.

How to Read These Symbols

Symbol	Reads as	Meaning
$\sin(A \pm B)$	sine of A plus/minus B	$\sin A \cos B \pm \cos A \sin B$
$\cos(A \pm B)$	cosine of A plus/minus B	$\cos A \cos B \mp \sin A \sin B$
$R \sin(x + \phi)$	R sine x plus phi	harmonic addition, $R = \sqrt{a^2 + b^2}$
$\arcsin x$	arcsine of x	angle in $[-\frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{\pi}{2}]$ with sine x
$e^{i\theta}$	e to the i theta	$\cos \theta + i \sin \theta$ (Euler)

Symbol	Reads as	Meaning
$T_n(x)$	T sub n of x	Chebyshev polynomial: $T_n(\cos \theta) = \cos(n\theta)$
$\sum$	sigma / sum	Fourier series: sum of sines and cosines
$n \in \mathbb{Z}$	n in Z	n is any integer

Terminology

What we called it	Mathematical term	Notation
splitting/merging angles	sum and difference identities	$\sin(A \pm B), \cos(A \pm B)$
double/half/triple angle	multiple-angle formulas	$\sin 2\theta, \sin 3\theta$
combining into one wave	harmonic addition	$a \sin x + b \cos x = R \sin(x + \phi)$
product becomes sum	product-to-sum identities	$\sin A \cos B = \frac{1}{2}[\sin(A + B) + \sin(A - B)]$
sum becomes product	sum-to-product identities	$\sin A + \sin B = 2 \sin \frac{A+B}{2} \cos \frac{A-B}{2}$
removing squares	power-reduction	$\sin^2 \theta = \frac{1 - \cos 2\theta}{2}$
universal trig substitution	Weierstrass substitution	$t = \tan \frac{x}{2}$
rotation in complex plane	Euler's formula	$e^{i\theta} = \cos \theta + i \sin \theta$
power to multiple angle	De Moivre's theorem	$(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)^n = \cos(n\theta) + i \sin(n\theta)$

What we called it	Mathematical term	Notation
cosines as polynomials	Chebyshev polynomials	$T_n(\cos \theta) = \cos(n\theta)$
cubic with 3 real roots	casus irreducibilis	solved via $x = 2\sqrt{-p/3} \cos \theta$
infinite product for π	Viete's formula	$\frac{2}{\pi} = \cos \frac{\pi}{4} \cos \frac{\pi}{8} \cdots$
wave decomposition	Fourier series	$f(x) = \frac{a_0}{2} + \sum (a_n \cos nx + b_n \sin nx)$

Next: [12A1 — Complex Numbers](#) — where Euler's formula becomes your engine for rotation, roots, and beyond.